SPIRITUAL/RELIGIOUS FALSE BELIEF #116 · THE END TIMES

“I should live in constant fear of the end times.”

✦ ✦ ✦

Where it often comes from

Frightening movies, books, or sermons about the end of the world. Childhood fear of being left behind. News of wars, disasters, and unrest. Teaching that focused on terror rather than hope. An anxious temperament that fixes on worst-case scenarios.

What Scripture teaches

Jesus spoke honestly about hard days ahead, but He told His followers, “See to it that you are not alarmed.” He said that when these things happen, believers should lift up their heads, because their redemption is drawing near. God has not given us a spirit of fear but of power, love, and self-control. For believers, Christ’s return is called “the blessed hope.” The end of the story is Jesus making all things new.

> *“When these things begin to happen, stand up and lift up your heads, because your redemption is drawing near”* **(Luke 21:28)**.

Also see

> “You will hear of wars and rumors of wars, but see to it that you are not alarmed. These things must happen, but the end is still to come” **(Matthew 24:6)**.

> “For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control” **(2 Timothy 1:7)**.

> “Peace I leave with you; My peace I give to you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled; do not be afraid” **(John 14:27)**.

> “As we await the blessed hope and glorious appearance of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ” **(Titus 2:13)**.

Common self-statements

- The end of the world terrifies me.
- Every news story makes me panic.
- I can’t enjoy life because the end might come.
- I should be afraid if I’m taking this seriously.
- Something terrible is about to happen.
- I can’t stop thinking about the end times.

Common logical errors

- **Catastrophizing:** Imagining the worst possible future.
- **Mental filter:** Focusing on judgment while overlooking the blessed hope.
- **Fortune telling:** Predicting disaster for yourself without basis.
- **Rumination:** Repeatedly consuming frightening content.

Challenging questions

- What did Jesus say about being alarmed?
- What should believers do when these things begin, according to Luke 21:28?
- What kind of spirit has God given me?
- Why does Scripture call Christ's return "the blessed hope"?
- Is the content I consume increasing fear or faith?
- Who holds the future?
- What would living with hope look like today?

Truth summary

> I do not have to live in constant fear of the end times. Jesus told me not to be alarmed. God has given me a spirit of power, love, and self-control. For believers, Christ's return is the blessed hope, and the end of the story is Jesus making all things new. I can lift up my head with hope.

Related Pearls topics

Click a topic to open it in the Pearls Scripture Search:

- End Times
- Second Coming
- Fear
- Anxiety/Worry
- Peace

Godly Counsel Lessons:

From the book *Godly Counsel* by Dr. Brian Campbell. Click a lesson to open it. You can read it on screen or print it.

- Anxiety/Worry/Fear
- Belief/Salvation

Listen: Overcoming Anxiety

> **Overcoming Anxiety** · Dr. Brian Campbell · about 18 minutes

Each morning ask: "If I truly believed God's truth instead of this lie, how would I think, speak, and act today?"

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

My Plan for Replacing "I should live in constant fear of the end times"

✦ ✦ ✦

Read through each section and **check the one that fits you best**. If none of them fit, write your own. One choice per section is enough. A truth you choose for yourself will stick better than one handed to you.

Name: _____ **Date started:** _____

1 How strongly do I believe the lie?

Rate it now so you can see your progress later.

"I should live in constant fear of the end times." I believe this _____ % (0 = not at all, 100 = completely)

2 My best question

The one question I will ask myself every time the lie shows up.

- ☐ What did Jesus say about being alarmed?
- ☐ What should I do when these things happen?
- ☐ What spirit has God given me?
- ☐ Why is Christ's return a blessed hope?
- ☐ Is my media increasing fear or faith?
- ☐ Who holds the future?

My own question: _____

3 My replacement truth

The statement I will say to myself instead of the lie.

- ☐ Jesus told me not to be alarmed.
- ☐ God has not given me a spirit of fear.
- ☐ Christ's return is my blessed hope.
- ☐ I can lift up my head; my redemption is near.
- ☐ Jesus gives me His peace.
- ☐ The end of the story is Jesus making all things new.

In my own words: _____

4 My Scripture

The verse that speaks most directly to me. This is the one I will memorize.

- [ ] **Luke 21:28**
  "When these things begin to happen, stand up and lift up your heads, because your redemption is drawing near."
- [ ] **Matthew 24:6**
  "You will hear of wars and rumors of wars, but see to it that you are not alarmed. These things must happen, but the end is still to come."
- [ ] **2 Timothy 1:7**
  "For God has not given us a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control."
- [ ] **John 14:27**
  "Peace I leave with you; My peace I give to you. I do not give to you as the world gives. Do not let your hearts be troubled; do not be afraid."
- [ ] **Titus 2:13**
  "As we await the blessed hope and glorious appearance of our great God and Savior Jesus Christ."

A verse I found myself: _____

✦ ✦ ✦

HOMEWORK · REPLACE AND REHEARSE

Practicing the Truth

✦ ✦ ✦

5 My practice plan

Everyone does the first three. Then pick one or two extra tools.

EVERYONE DOES THESE

- ☐ **Make my Truth Card** (below). Carry it and read it at least three times a day.
- ☐ **Memorize my Scripture** from Step 4.
- ☐ **Set reminders** to silently repeat my truth. Check one or more:
  - ☐ **A buzz:** my watch or phone vibrates every _____ minutes
  - ☐ **An everyday event:** every time I _____
  - ☐ **A visual reminder:** something I will see often, such as a sticky note on my mirror, my truth as the background picture on my phone, or a note on my car dashboard.

PICK ONE OR TWO THAT FIT ME

- ☐ **Hope log:** Each day, write one reason the return of Jesus gives me hope.
- ☐ **My name in Scripture:** Rewrite my verse with my name in it and read it aloud each morning.
  *For example, 2 Timothy 1:7 becomes: "For God has not given **Sarah** a spirit of fear, but of power, love, and self-control."*
- ☐ **Gratitude journal:** Each night, write three things I thank God for.
- ☐ **Truth recording:** Record my own voice reading my Truth Card and verse, and listen in the car or on a walk.
- ☐ **Reading:** The "End Times" topic in Pearls.
- ☐ **Listening:** The Overcoming Anxiety audio by Dr. Brian Campbell. Tap to play.

6 My action step this week

Do one thing that tests the lie in real life.

- ☐ **Limit end-times videos, news, or articles** for one week, and notice your anxiety level.
- ☐ **Read Revelation 21:1–7,** and write what the very end looks like.
- ☐ **When fear rises, read Luke 21:28 aloud** and take one useful step in your day.
- ☐ **Talk with a pastor or counselor** if end-times fear is affecting your sleep or daily life.

What I will do: _____

When: _____

What the lie predicts will happen: _____

7 End-of-week check-in

Bring this page to your next session.

What actually happened: _____

What I learned: _____

The lie "I should live in constant fear of the end times": _____ % **My truth:** _____ %

Daily practice tracker

Day	Read my card	Said my verse	Used my reminder	One reason for hope
Mon				
Tue				
Wed				
Thu				
Fri				
Sat				
Sun				

My Truth Card

THE LIE

~~I should live in constant fear of the end times.~~

THE TRUTH

_____

_____

GOD'S WORD

_____

_____

Copy onto a 3×5 card, or cut along the dashed line and carry it with you.

Prayer

Lord Jesus, thank You that Your return is my blessed hope. Help me reject the lie that I should live in constant fear of the end times. Give me Your peace, a spirit of power, love, and self-control, and help me lift up my head with hope. In Your name, Amen.

✦ ✦ ✦

Scripture quotations are from the Berean Standard Bible (BSB), which is in the public domain.